



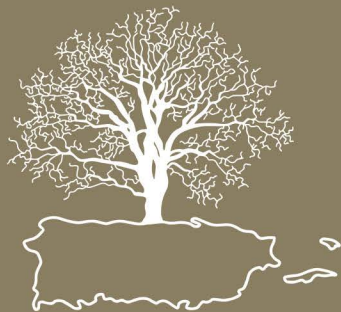
A 4x4 grid of 16 images, each showing a pair of hands holding a different handmade object against a black background. The objects include: a cigar, a piece of paper with a drawing, a small wooden wheel, a bundle of sticks, a knife, a small owl figurine, a small woven basket, a colorful mask, a large knife, a small green bowl, a small wooden loom, a small green house, a small doll, a small woven basket, a small wooden toy car, a small white object, a small woven basket, and a small woven basket.

Artesanías

“Artesanías” or crafts are hand-made creations, which makes each piece fundamentally unique.

Their confection is delicate in time, resources and technique; yet the end result is an object of transcendence.

Within each tradition, artisans project their personal creative vision, manifesting a world of diverse utensils, clothing, ornaments and art, all rooted in an ancestry that connects us.



Obras del País



Our Mission

Obras del País is a nonprofit organization recognized as a 501(c)(3) in the United States and under Section 1101.01 in Puerto Rico. Founded in 2021, its mission is to position Puerto Rico's artisanal heritage as a catalyst for educational, social, and economic development.

Through the production of high-quality documentary films, photography, and a publicly accessible digital archive of Puerto Rican artisans and traditional crafts, the organization preserves traditional knowledge while transforming these stories into tools for visibility, education, and opportunity.

Its work connects ancestral crafts with new generations and global audiences through community exhibitions, educational initiatives, strategic digital distribution, and partnerships with cultural institutions.



Founders

Rafael Fernández
Anisabel Torruella
Isaak Gonzalo



Isaak Gonzalo

Obras del País Co-Founder,
Executive Director,
Documentary Filmmaker

Bachelor's degree in Education and Technology. He has over 10 years of experience leading projects at the intersection of the creative industries and education.



Lourdes Cortés

Media Producer,
Video Editor,
Graphic Designer

Bachelor's degree in Fine Arts with a concentration in Visual Arts. Passionate about the arts, tourism, and Puerto Rican folklore, she joined Obras del País in 2021.

1 Production

We film at the artisan's workshop and key community locations, providing an intimate opportunity to observe their creative process and learn about their journey.



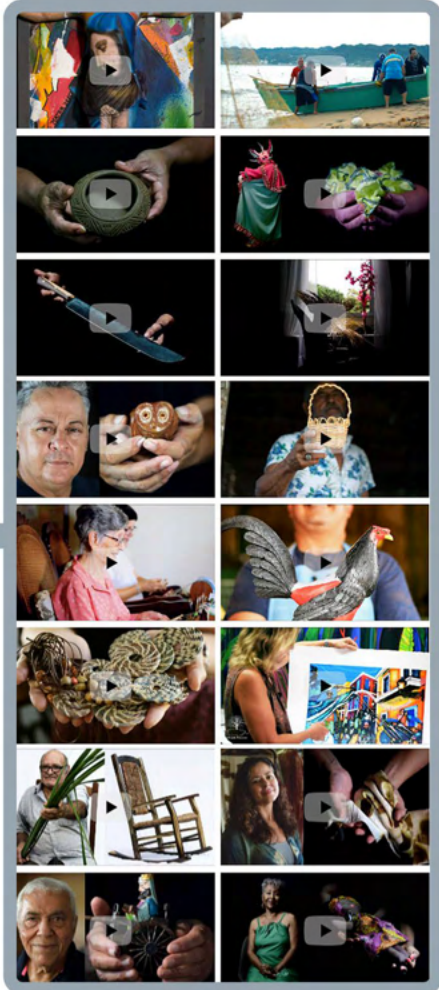
2 Publishing

Our productions are made freely accessible through the project's website and social media platforms, ensuring public access to these stories. While the primary audience is the Puerto Rican community — both on the island and throughout the diaspora — the project has reached audiences internationally.

Each documentary is accompanied by a **digital profile of the artisan** that includes photographs and direct contact information. This platform facilitates collaborations, commissions, and authentic connections between artisans and audiences.

To date, Obras del País has produced **38 documentaries across 29 municipalities**. Our long-term goal is to document 100 artisans and visit all 78 municipalities of Puerto Rico, creating a comprehensive audiovisual archive of the island's living craft traditions.

The project's online gallery also provides **educational resources** designed to foster cultural pride, support intergenerational learning, and expand access to traditional knowledge that is at risk of disappearing.



3 Community

Obras del País collaborates with educators, community leaders, and cultural institutions to develop meaningful public programming. These initiatives include community film screenings, demonstration workshops with artisans, curated exhibitions, public lectures, and educational projects that integrate our documentaries into classroom curricula.

All documentaries are produced in Spanish with English subtitles, ensuring accessibility for both local and international audiences. In alignment with our commitment to **cultural accessibility**, beginning with episode 37 we have incorporated American Sign Language interpretation into our productions.





Impact

Data corresponding to the year 2025:

2.1 Million

views across our platforms

Audience

80% in Puerto Rico

16% in United States

4% international viewership

"As a dedicated educator in this field, I have had the privilege of incorporating Obras del País' content into our lesson plans, and I can confidently attest to the immense value it brings to our curriculum."

Monica Olivera, Founder of Hispanic Heritage Studies

"Organizations such as Obras del País play a vital role in preserving our cultural heritage by highlighting the talents of our artisans and supporting their efforts to ensure their work endures for future generations. The Puerto Rico Museum of Art looks forward to the continuation and expansion of this collaboration."

Viviana García Meléndez, Project Coordinator
Museo de Arte de Puerto Rico

"I am also inspired by their innovative approach to education through micro-documentaries and other accessible storytelling formats, which beautifully illuminate the richness of these traditions and help broaden public understanding of their cultural significance."

Robin Morey, Collections Specialist
Smithsonian's National Museum of the American Latino

"Your great work and commitment has helped us incredibly to connect with Puerto Rican artisans."

Paolo Sorbello, Destination Manager, The Reserve LLC

"The documentary produced by Obras del País, filmed in collaboration with our Vejigantes de la Playa de Ponce troupe, the Ponce Fénix Marching Band, and the Casa Museo del Vejigante Miguel Pérez, beautifully showcases the art and cultural pride that define our community."

Gilberto Limardo, Esq.
President, Vejigantes de la Playa de Ponce Carnival Organization

More than 90% of participating artisans report measurable increases in sales, collaborations, and public recognition following the release of their documentaries.



"The impact of the documentary has allowed my dolls to become internationally known, leading to cultural exchange connections with England, Brazil, Argentina, and the United States."

**Teresa Meléndez-Padilla,
Artisan**



"Since the documentary was released, I have received a constant stream of calls and messages from people congratulating me and discovering my work through your project."

**Debora Feliciano,
Artisan**



"It has become a reference point for people looking for artisans in my field and places my work in a visible and respected professional category."

**Gladys Serrano,
Artisan**

Each documentary connects an artisan to a broader cultural and creative economy.

Many of the artisans we document had little or no digital presence prior to participating in the project. Through our work, they receive high-quality audiovisual storytelling, professional photography, and long-term visibility through a trusted cultural platform.

This combination allows their work to reach new audiences, institutions, and markets while preserving the cultural knowledge embedded in their craft.





Why this work matters

Now

Traditional crafts in Puerto Rico carry centuries of cultural memory, knowledge, and identity. Yet many of these practices face increasing challenges as master artisans age, younger generations migrate, and handmade traditions compete with mass production.

In recent years, natural disasters such as hurricanes and earthquakes, along with the economic disruptions of the pandemic, have further threatened the livelihoods of many artisans and the continuity of their traditions. These circumstances make the documentation and visibility of these cultural practices more important than ever.

Join us

in Preserving Puerto Rico's Cultural Heritage

Preserving cultural heritage is a collective effort. We welcome opportunities to collaborate with organizations, institutions, and communities across the Puerto Rican archipelago and throughout the diaspora to safeguard and share Puerto Rico's living traditions.



ObrasdelPais.com



*Hay historias que, si no las contamos,
se perderán para siempre.*

Website: www.ObrasdelPais.com

Phone: 787-222-8103

E-mail: hola@obrasdelpais.com

Facebook: [obrasdelpais](https://www.facebook.com/obrasdelpais)

Instagram: [@obrasdelpais](https://www.instagram.com/obrasdelpais)

YouTube: [@obrasdelpais](https://www.youtube.com/obrasdelpais)



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